

“…IF A STORY IS IN TUNE COMPLETELY WITH THE TRUTH OF LIFE, TRUTH AS I PERCEIVE IT, THEN IT WILL AUTOMATICALLY BE SIGNIFICANT. BUT I NEVER THINK UP SPECIFIC PROBLEMS AND THEN WRITE A STORY ABOUT THEM. I WRITE THE STORY.”

RK Narayan was born Rasipuram Krishnaswami Iyer Narayanaswami in the city of Madras. His first novel, *Swami and Friends*, was published in England in 1935 after several rejections. It remains a beloved classic even today. Like many of his later works, the novel is set in the fictional town of Malgudi in south India. Although these stories take place during the eventful pre- and post-Independence years, they are intensely focused on the personal lives of his characters. His stories are about people, their relationships and flaws, and the sorrows and joys of their lives, all told in his distinctive gently comic style. Narayan’s work was popular both in India as well as abroad; among his many admirers were literary greats like Graham Greene, Somerset Maugham and EM Forster.